Northwind Cycles - Employee Handbook 2026

Welcome

Northwind Cycles designs and assembles electric bicycles in Turin, Italy. This handbook explains the policies that apply to all permanent employees. Questions about any policy go to the People Team at people@northwind.example.

Working hours

The standard working week is 38 hours, Monday to Friday. Core hours, when everyone is expected to be available, are 10:00 to 15:00. Outside core hours, employees choose their own start and finish times.

Remote work

Office-based staff may work remotely up to two days per week. Workshop and assembly staff work on site because their work needs the production line. Remote days are agreed with your manager at the start of each month.

Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 26 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, plus Italian public holidays. Up to 5 unused days can be carried over to the next year, and they must be used by 31 March. Leave requests should be made at least two weeks ahead.

Sick leave

Employees who are ill must tell their manager before 9:30 on the first day of absence. A medical certificate is required from the third consecutive day.

Parental leave

Northwind tops up statutory parental leave pay to 100 percent of salary for the first 8 weeks, for every parent regardless of gender.

Expenses

Work travel is booked through the travel portal. Train is preferred to flying for trips under 4 hours. Meal expenses are reimbursed up to 35 euros per day with receipts. Claims must be submitted within 30 days of the expense.

Employee bike scheme

Every employee can lease one Northwind e-bike at a 40 percent discount, paid from gross salary over 24 months. Bikes in the scheme are covered by the standard product warranty and by free servicing at the Turin workshop.

Equipment

Laptops are replaced every 4 years. Lost or damaged equipment must be reported to IT within 24 hours.